

Phishing Awareness

Pause. Verify. Protect.

Learning Objectives:

Understand

Understand what phishing is

Recognize

Recognize common tactics

Know

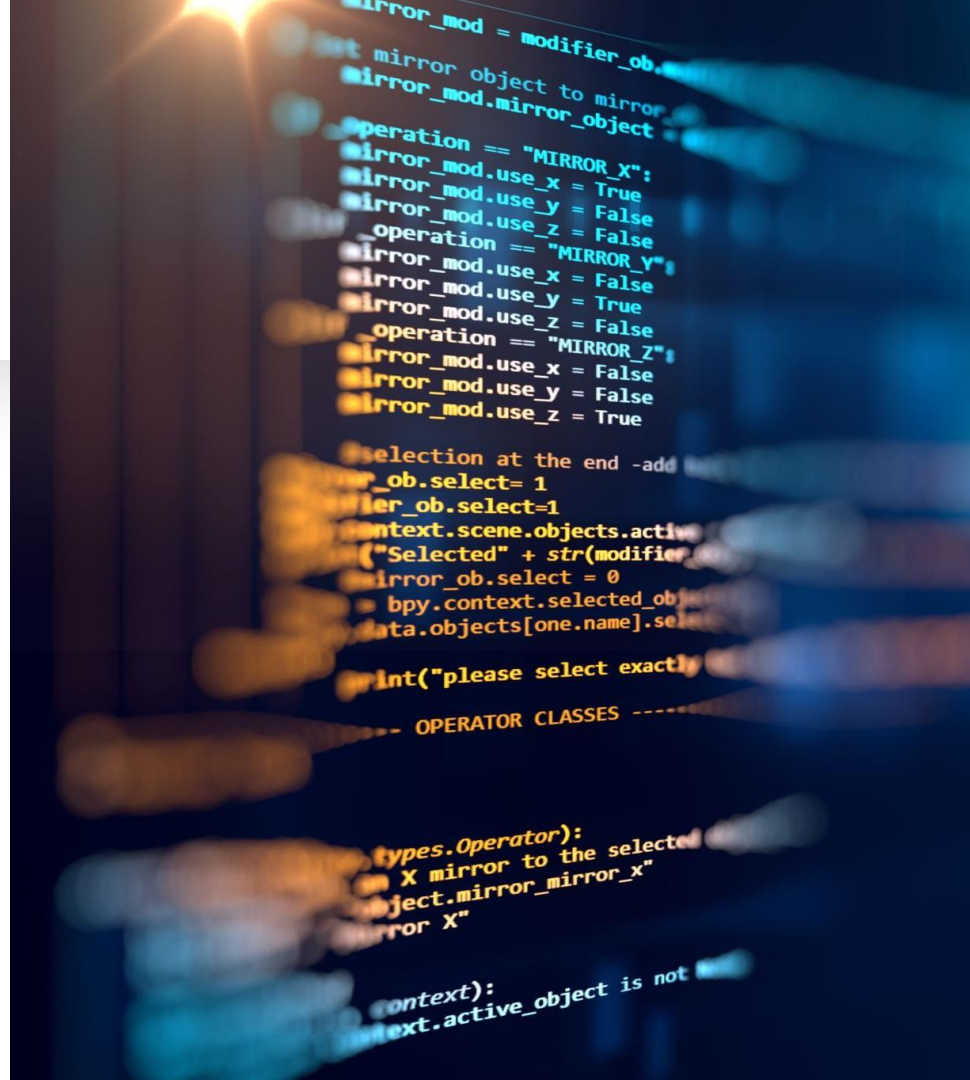
Know how to respond safely

Identify

Identify warning signs

What is Phishing?

- Attackers using human nature to their advantage
- Attackers pretending to be someone you trust online
- The goal is to steal personal information (like accounts), money, or steal information
- Can happen through email, text, QR codes



Why you could be a target:



YOU HAVE
PERSONAL
INFORMATION



YOU HAVE ACCESS
TO SCHOOL
SYSTEMS



AND YOU MAY HAVE
ACCESS TO EMAIL
ACCOUNTS



ATTACKERS CAN
TARGET EVERYONE,
NOT JUST SYSTEMS

Types of Phishing

- Email Phishing
- Smishing (Text Message)
- QR Phishing
- Credential Harvesting (Fake login pages)
- (All this explain more)



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Real World Examples:

NOTICE Unread Inbox x

donotreply: dromestralke@gmail.com
to: bcc: me

IT DEPARTMENT

Dear Student,

We've detected unusual activity on your account, and it is at risk of deactivation.
To avoid account closure, please click the link below within the next 24 hours:

<https://student.hocking.edu>

Failure to do so may result in account termination.
Thank you for your cooperation and commitment to keeping Hocking's digital environment secure.

Division of Information Technology

ITC: cng
3301 Hocking Plaza, Nelsonville, OH

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[Reply](#) [Forward](#) [More](#)

Re: Updates Amazon Service | Fraud Payment Detection - Purchase of "AMAZON PRIME" on Amazon Market Place on Tue, April 14, 2020 KCHZPQR Nous avons envoyé une confirmation de mise à jour du mot de passe sur le compte



Amazon.com <id@amazon.com>
Tue, 4/14/2020 10:00 AM
account-updates@amazon.com

Hi, I'm David C. Brown

Your Account | Order History | Amazon App

Hello,

We are having trouble with your payment. Please verify or update your payment details include (such as expiry date and billing address). Valid payment information must be received within 5 days.

We hope see you again soon.
Amazon.com

[Update Your Payment](#)

We hope you found this message to be useful. However, if you do not receive future updates or if you need help, please contact us.
Please note that product prices and availability are subject to change. Prices and availability shown on the Amazon website and the Amazon App may differ from those on our website and the Amazon App.
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[PayPal]: Your account access has been limited
Team <support-services@paypal-accounts.com>
to: me



Dear PayPal customer,

Your PayPal account is limited, You have 24 hours to solve the problem or your account will be permanently disabled.

We are sorry to inform you that you no longer have access to PayPal's advantages like purchasing, and sending and receiving money.

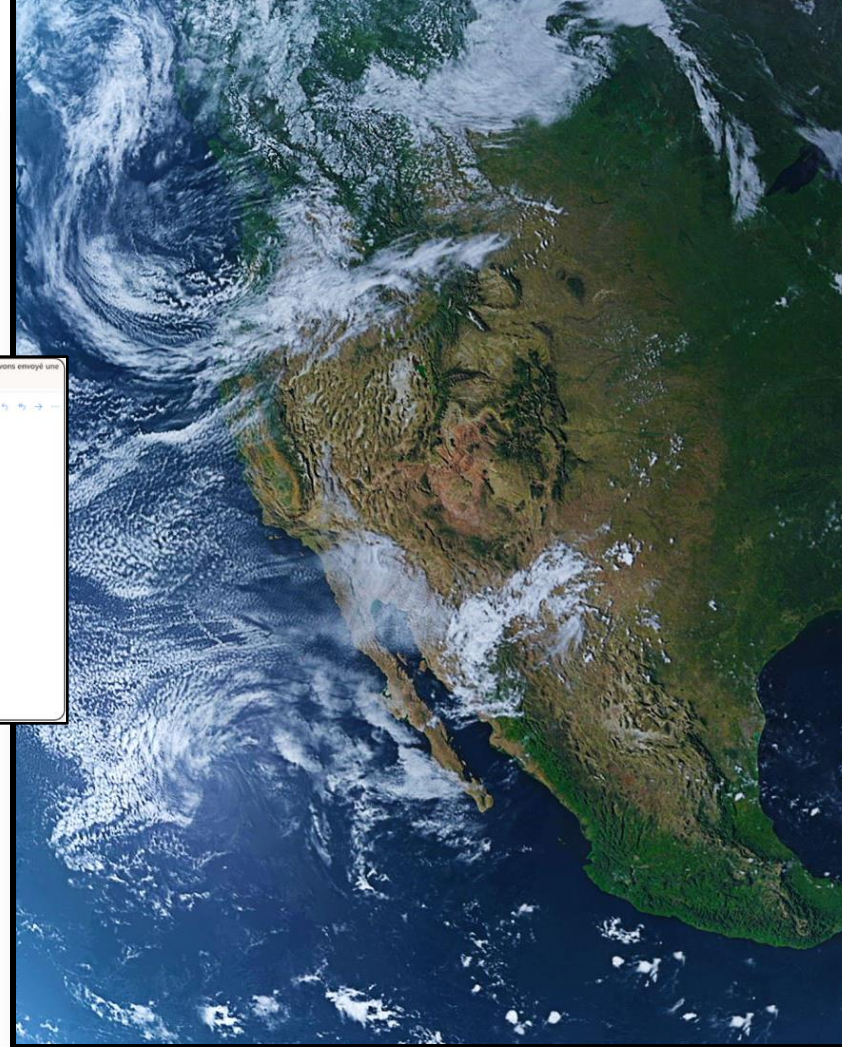
Why is my PayPal account limited?

We believe that your account is in danger from unauthorized users.

What can I do to resolve the problem?

You have to confirm all of your account details on our secured server by clicking the link below and following the steps.

[Confirm Your Information](#)



Why Phishing Works



Phishing plays on human emotions:



Urgency



Fear



Authority



Curiosity



Pressure or feeling rushed is a red flag

Common warning signs

Threatening or urgent language

Misspellings and grammatical errors

Unusual email addresses

Suspicious links or QR codes

Email Red Flags

- Very generic
- Sender address and name do not match
- Strange formatting
- Misspelled address
- Unplanned attachments



QR Code Risks



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Can redirect to fake login pages

Can hide the actual link

Can be common in public places

Seem convenient, but can't see where they are leading you before you scan

Question:

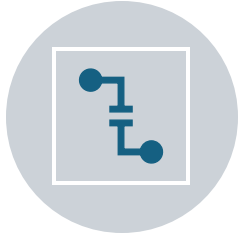


What You Should Do

Stop-Check-Report

- Don't click
- Verify the message
- Have AI verify the legitimacy of the message
- Report it to IT
- Delete it

If you click



Disconnect from the network



Report the incident



Change your passwords



Monitor your accounts for suspicious activity

Password Safety

- Use strong Passwords:
- Unique
- Contain symbols, letters, numbers
- At a minimum 8, generally 12 characters
- Enable multi-factor authentication
- Never share passwords
- Especially over text, email, or phone
- Test how safe your password is:

<https://www.passwordmonster.com/>

- <https://www.security.org/how-secure-is-my-password/>

Your password requires:

- ✗ 1. At least 8 characters
- 2. At least 2 from these 3 groups:
 - ✓ Letters (abc = ABC, no ÄÖÜ)
 - ✗ Digits
 - ✗ Special characters (-./',;&@#*)(_+:")

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Importance of Reporting

- Protect Others
- Build a stronger and safer campus
- Helps IT stop attacks early

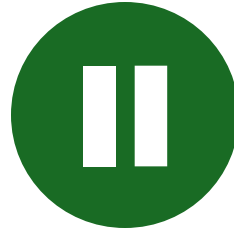


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Key Takeaways



Phishing is
everywhere



PAUSE VERIFY
PROTECT



Report suspicious
activity

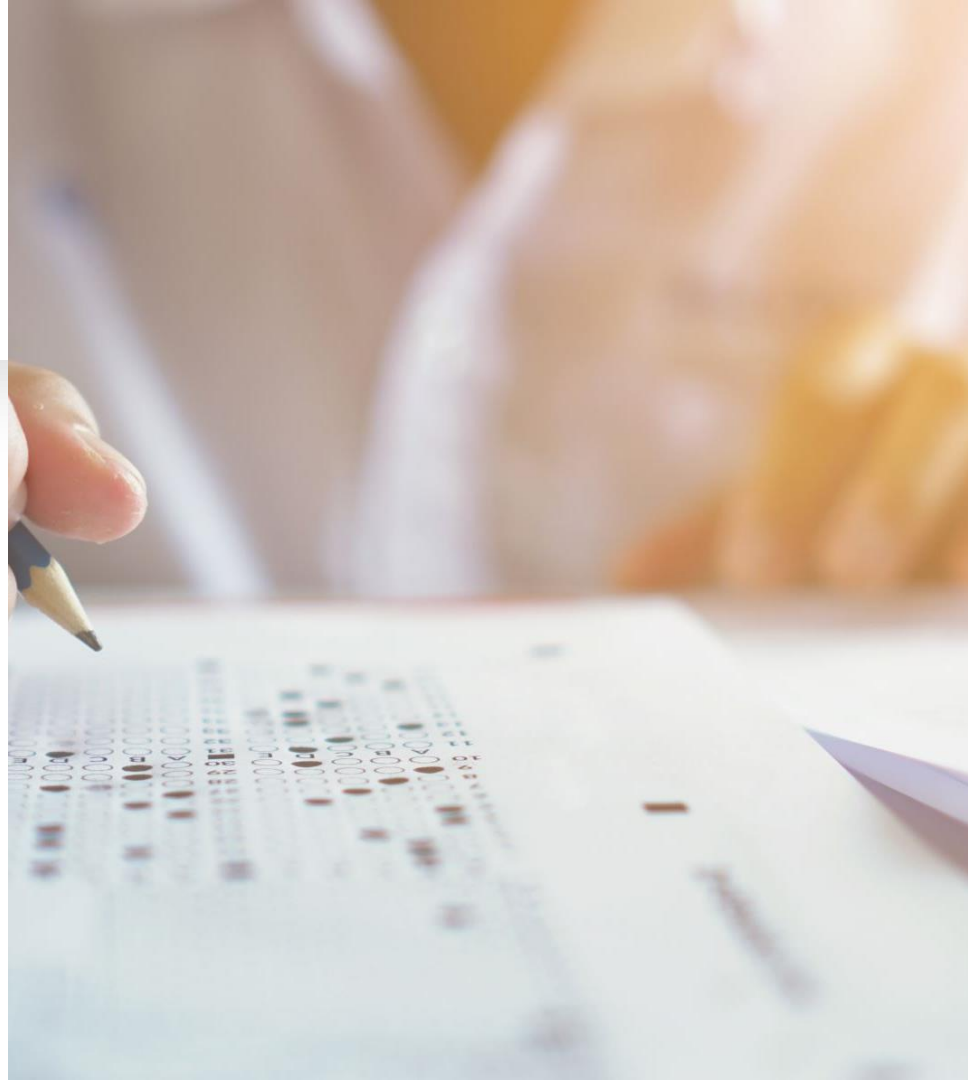


If unsure use AI to
verify legitimacy

Quick Quiz:

- What is most suspicious?
 - A. Email about an assignment from your professor
 - B. A school newsletter
 - C. An email about you having money to claim within 24 hours

Answer: C



Reminder:

- Pause. Verify. Protect
- PhishGuard AI:
- A ChatGPT bot created to help users determine if an email is phishing them.
- <https://chatgpt.com/g/g-69e96299d35c81919b69ed303ab821e7-phishguard-ai>





Thank you!

Any questions?

